



Unit-3

Technical Communication



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Topics to discuss:

- ▶ Public Speaking
- ▶ Group discussion
- ▶ Presentation Strategies
- ▶ Interview Skills
- ▶ Negotiation Skills
- ▶ Critical and Creative thinking in Communication



Public Speaking Skills

Public Speaking Skills:

- ▶ Public Speaking skill may be defined as the art of appearing in front of an audience, facing the audience; presenting your speech and making them understand what you want them to understand within the limited time and resources given to you.
- ▶ There can be different forms of public speaking like:
 - Short talks/presentations
 - Discussions/group discussions
 - Meetings
 - Briefings/ instructions
 - Debates
 - Seminars
- ▶ All these involve an audience.

Speech Style:

- ▶ If we talk about everyday 'speaking skill', there are different speeches styles like:
 - Formal - as in interviews.
 - Informal – as you use it with close friends.
 - Polite – using the word 'please' and 'thank you' while talking.
 - Normal
 - Strong – when you want to admonish someone.
 - Blunt – when you want to snub someone
 - Tentative – using the words 'may be', 'I do not know if I could' etc.
 - Direct – when you are talking directly to someone like 'do this'.
 - The mood of the person who is talking.
 - The mood of the person who is listening.
 - Relationship between the persons who are talking to each other.
 - The situation they are in.
 - The subject they are talking on.

- ▶ The very fact that the spotlight is you is enough to trigger every fear, and anxiety you have ever had about public speaking.

- ▶ Here's why, you always think that:
 - You may be judged by all those people, and they may judge you badly.
 - You may feel like a fool.
 - You might make mistakes and lose your way.
 - You will be completely humiliated.

Barriers to Speaking:

- ▶ There are seven speaking skills barriers. They are:
 1. Physical barriers
 2. Perceptual barriers
 3. Emotional barriers
 4. Cultural barriers
 5. Language barriers
 6. Gender barriers
 7. Interpersonal barriers
 8. Barriers in communication in general

How to avoid communication barriers?

- ▶ To avoid barriers, start paying attention to the type of facial expressions we use.
 - ➔ Facial expressions must be appropriate based on the topic, listeners and objectives.
 - ➔ Add variety to your gestures by relaxing your arms back to your sides after you complete a gesture. Occasional positive gestures grab your listener's attention.
 - ➔ Keep your objective in mind. Think in terms of what your listener needs to know about what you want them to do, not what you want to tell them.
 - ➔ Minimize the use of words like UMMM', 'OH', 'LIKE' which are distracting and the listener can miss our message and do not lose eye contact with the audience.
 - ➔ Give the hand outs of PPT after the speech.
 - ➔ Take a moment to pause as you transition your eyes from one individual to another.

There are different types of speaking namely:

1. A conversations
 - a. Informal Conversation
 - b. Formal Conversation
2. Speaking in Beauty Pageants
3. Extemporaneous speech
4. Persuasive speech

There are several points of contrast.

- ➔ Persuasive speaking urges us to choose from informative speaking reveals and clarifies options.
- ➔ Persuasive speaking asks the audience for more commitment than does informative speaking.
- ➔ The ethical obligations for persuasive speakers are even greater than for informative speakers.
- ➔ The Persuasive speaker is a leader; the informative speaker is a teacher.
- ➔ Persuasive speaking more often involves emotional appeals that are out of place in speeches to inform.

Traditionally, persuasion involves:

- ➔ Ethos (credibility)
- ➔ Logos (logic)
- ➔ Pathos (emotion)

How to Overcome Fear of Public Speaking?:

- ▶ Public speaking is not comfortable, but once you are actually in front of your audience, pay attention to them. You must make your audience your friend!
- ▶ Rehearsal is very important.
- ▶ For delivering charismatic, assured and memorable performance, you must rehearse.
 1. **A speech is both a mental and a physical activity:**
 2. **Rehearsal gives you the strength to go the distance:**

Who? What? How? When? Why?

Who are you speaking to?

What are their interest?

What do they share in common with others?

The Public Speaking Audience can be divided into the following categories.

Age: Audience can be children, teens or youth, middle aged or elderly.

Teen agers have unique needs for public speakers to address. You must know the requirement to command the attention of group of young people. If you do just this one thing you will increase the effectiveness of your public speaking when it is to our youth.

- ➔ What do you wish to communicate?
- ➔ How can you best convey your message? Language is very important here. Plan a beginning, middle and end. Audio-visual aids must be prepared beforehand if time allows.
- ➔ When? Timing is important. There is a time to speak and a time to be silent.
- ➔ Where? You may have time to visit the room, for example, and rearrange the furniture. So check for availability and visibility if you are using audio or visual aids.
- ➔ Why? Listeners should be converted into admirers, you need to know why they should listen to you!



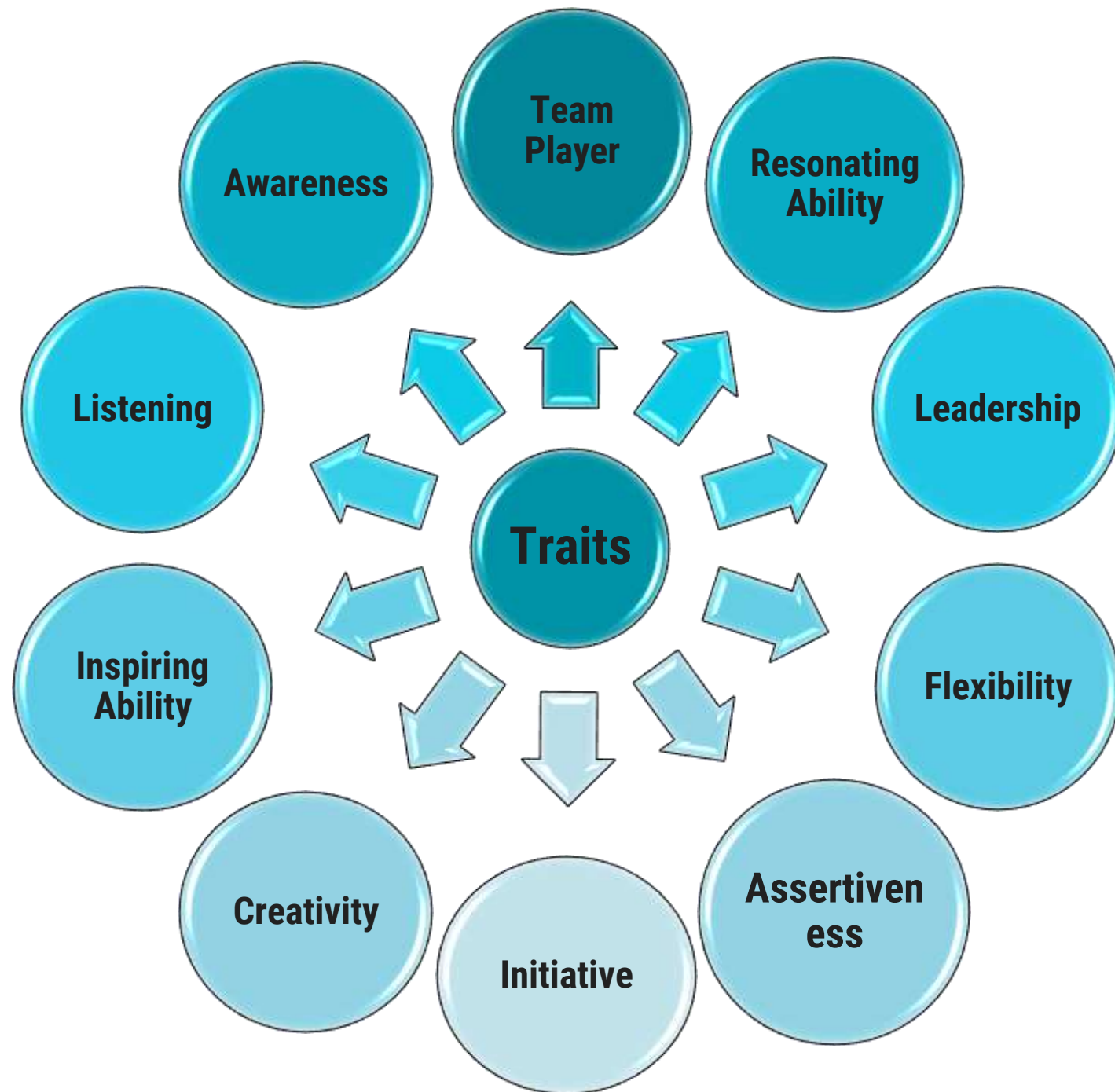
Group Discussion:

- ▶ Group discussions (GDs) are now being used as an important step in the selection of candidates both in private and government organizations.
- ▶ It is a formal discussion which involves six to fifteen participants who sit in a group to discuss a topic or a case given for this purpose.
- ▶ In GDs, the group members have to interpret, analyse, and argue, so as to discuss the topic or case threadbare as a team.

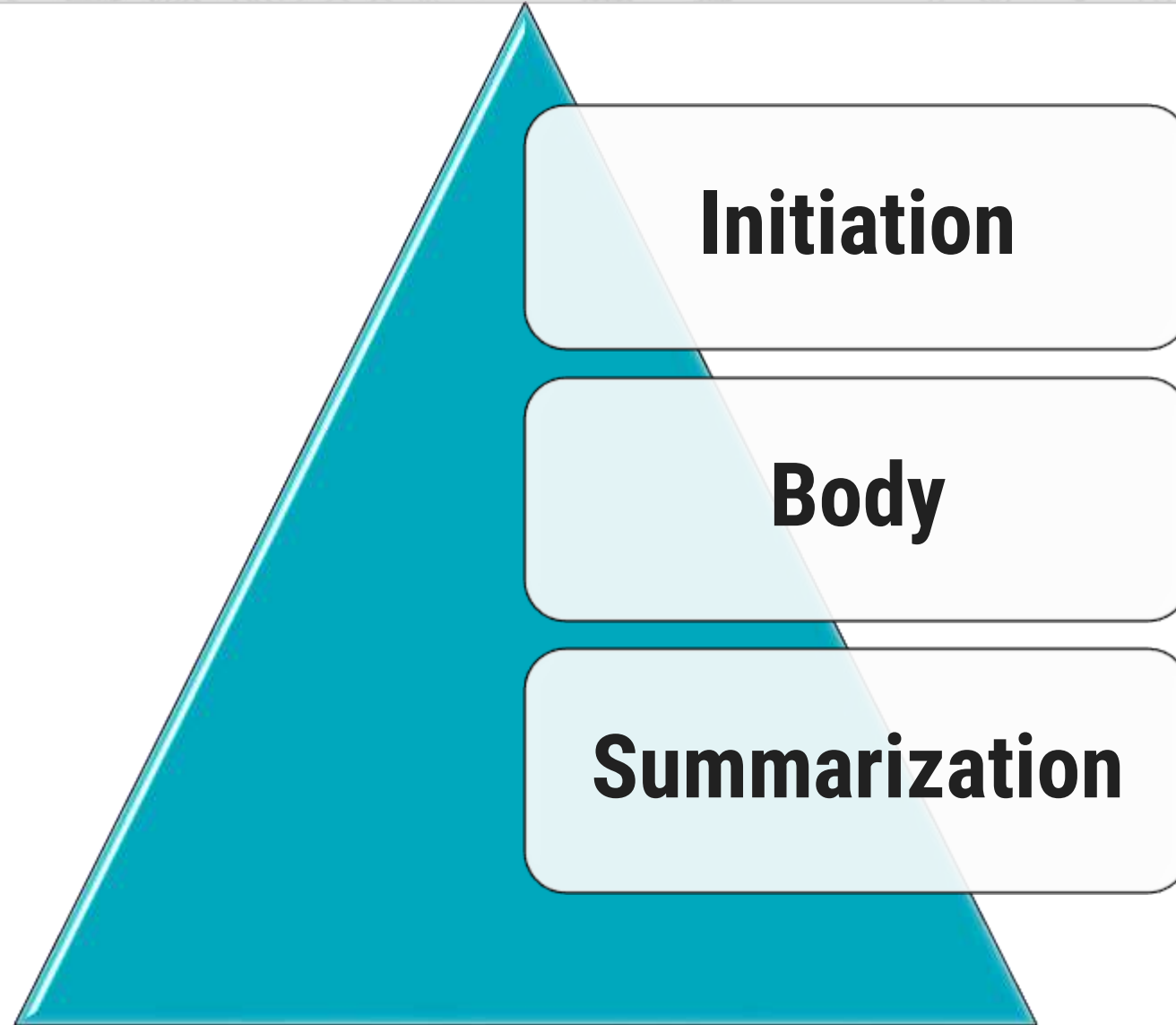


Difference between GD and Debate:

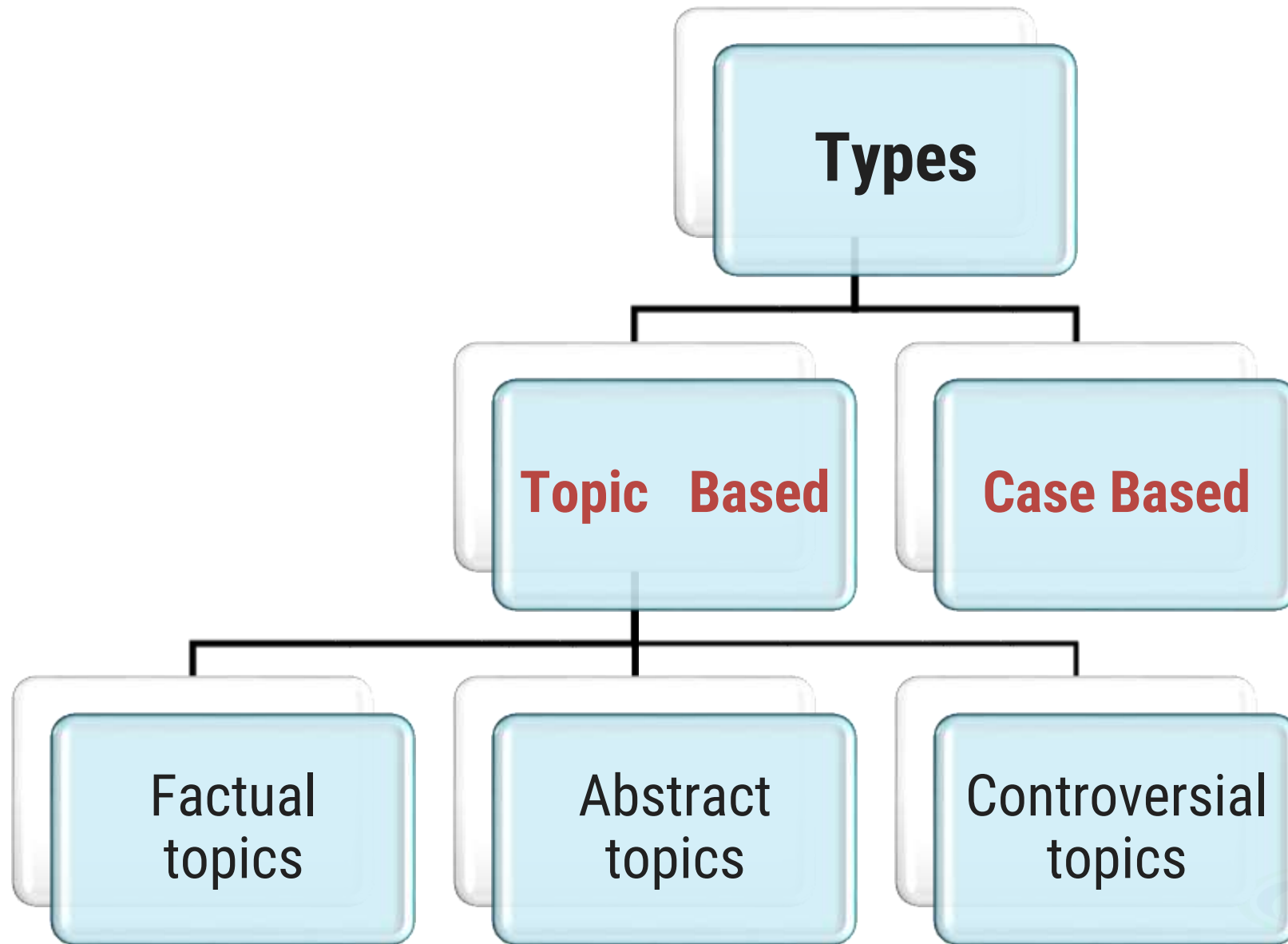
- ▶ In a debate, you are supposed to speak either for or against a motion.
- ▶ GDs, on the other hand, all the members of the group are expected to deliberate upon the issue extensively, and it is possible for any of them to change their stand if they find themselves convinced about the other side of the perspective.
- ▶ This kind of alteration in the stance does not find a place in debates where those who speak for the motion or against it prepare their argument well in advance, and the contestant is not supposed argue for both the sides.



Phases of GD:



Types of GD:



MISSION BUSINESS
PROJECT INNOVATION
CONCEPTUAL DEVELOP
DIRECTION
TEACHING
CAREER QUALIFICATION
ADMINISTRATION
SERVICES PROGRAM EXPERIENCE
ANALYSIS
STRATEGY REPORTING
VISION QUALIFICATION
DEVELOP SUCCESS
STRATEGY

PRESENTATION

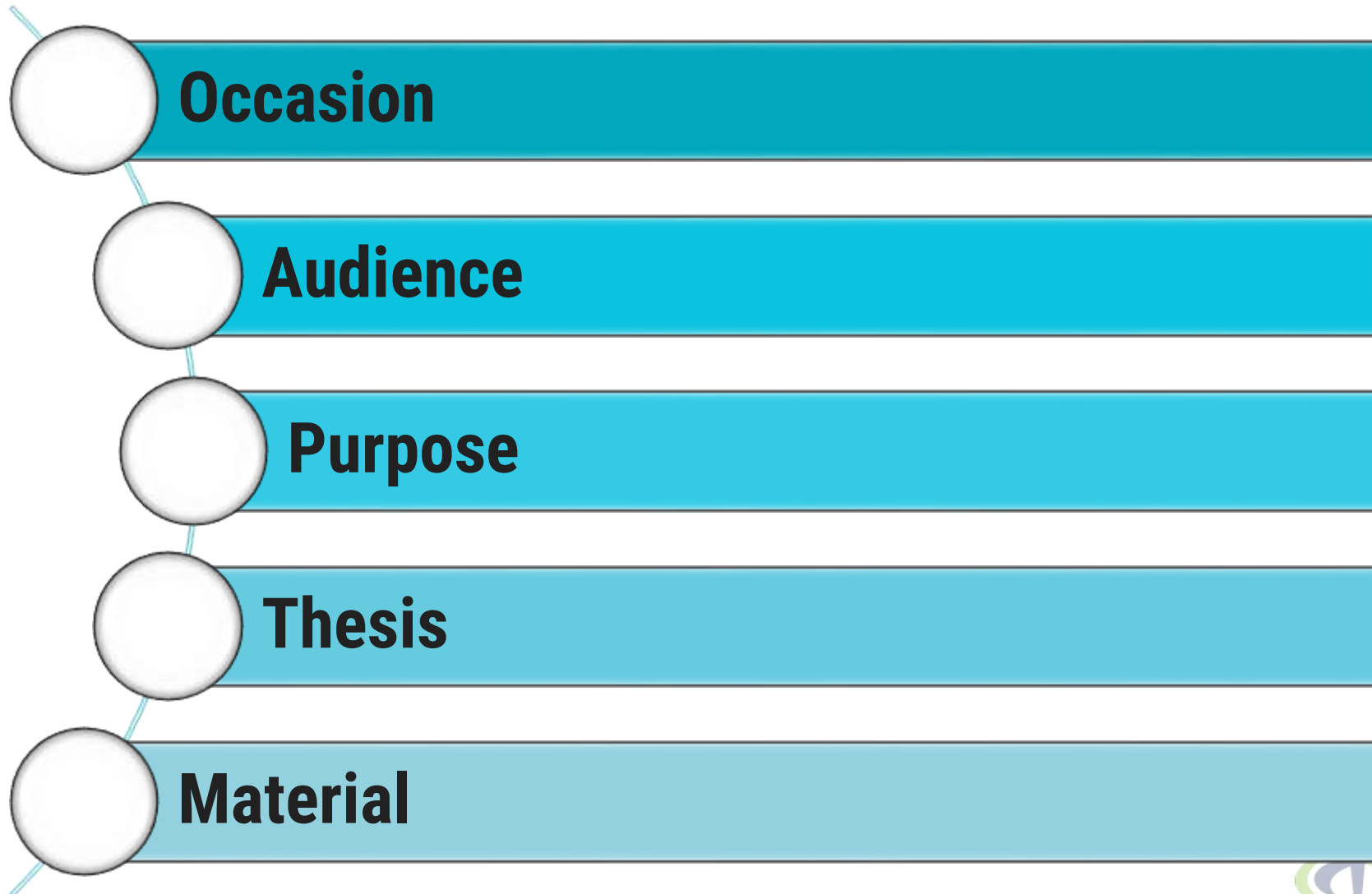
BUSINESS
PRACTICE
TRAINING
MISSION INNOVATION
LEADERSHIP PARTNERSHIP
DECISIONS
CAREER
HELP
COACH MOTIVATE
DEVELOP
WEBINAR
PROJECT
DEFINITION
PROCESS
COMPETENCIES
MANAGER
BUSINESS
ANALYSIS
EXPERIENCE
INNOVATION
TEACHING
POWER

Introduction:

- ▶ When you meet a group of people to talk about a new product, idea, topic or piece of work, it is called a ***presentation***.
- ▶ Points are to be attended to when preparing for a professional presentation:
 - Planning: occasion, audience, purpose, thesis and material
 - Outlining and structuring: introduction, main body and conclusion
 - Choosing the mode of delivery
 - Body language and voice
 - Visual aids



Planning for Presentation:



1. Occasion

► Facilities:

- ➔ Venue or locale along with the projection equipment, lighting, seating, ventilation etc.
- ➔ Every location has its unique physical environment.

► Time:

- ➔ The day of presentation.
- ➔ The duration of talk.

► Context:

- ➔ The events surrounding our presentation.

2. Audience:

- ▶ They are at the receiving end of our communication.
- ▶ Who can be in your audience?
- ▶ Understanding of audience would help the presenter to:
 - Build support
 - Anticipate problems
 - Consider strategies
 - Tune the approach
 - Competent delivery of content.
- ▶ Demand the questions from audience.

3. Purpose:

► There can be three different purposes of a presentation:

- to inform
- to analyse
- to persuade

4. Thesis Statement

- ▶ The thesis statement is very important in a presentation because it spells out the subject and establishes its impact among the audience.
- ▶ It is also a central idea of a presentation.
- ▶ Using a question or a sentence fragment should be avoided.
- ▶ Simple language should be used to frame a complete, declarative statement.

5. Material

- ▶ Complete formulating of thesis and develop the information that elaborates it.
- ▶ Collecting material requires some research.
- ▶ **For professional presentations:**
 - Need to consult the library,
 - Internet,
 - magazines,
 - newspapers,
 - organizational records,
 - statistics and publications.
 - collect information through surveys or interviews.
- ▶ Once we finish collecting material and ideas for our presentation, we should assemble them at one place. We may list all the ideas on a piece of paper and then organize them.

Organizing Content of Presentation (Outlining and Structuring):



Introduction

Main Body

Conclusion

Nuances (Modes) of Delivery:

Extemporaneous Mode

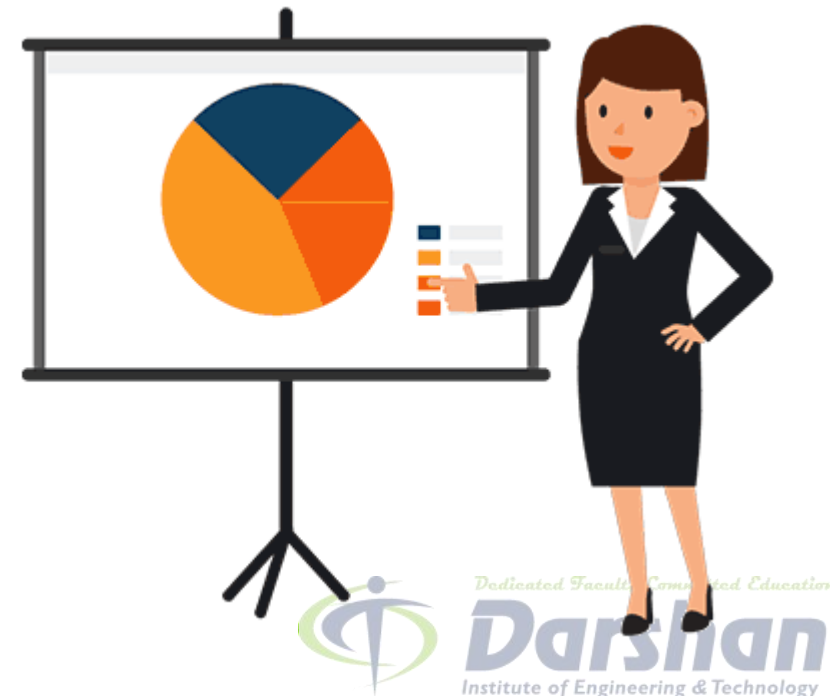
Manuscript Mode

Impromptu Mode

Memorization Mode

Visual Aids in Technical Communication :

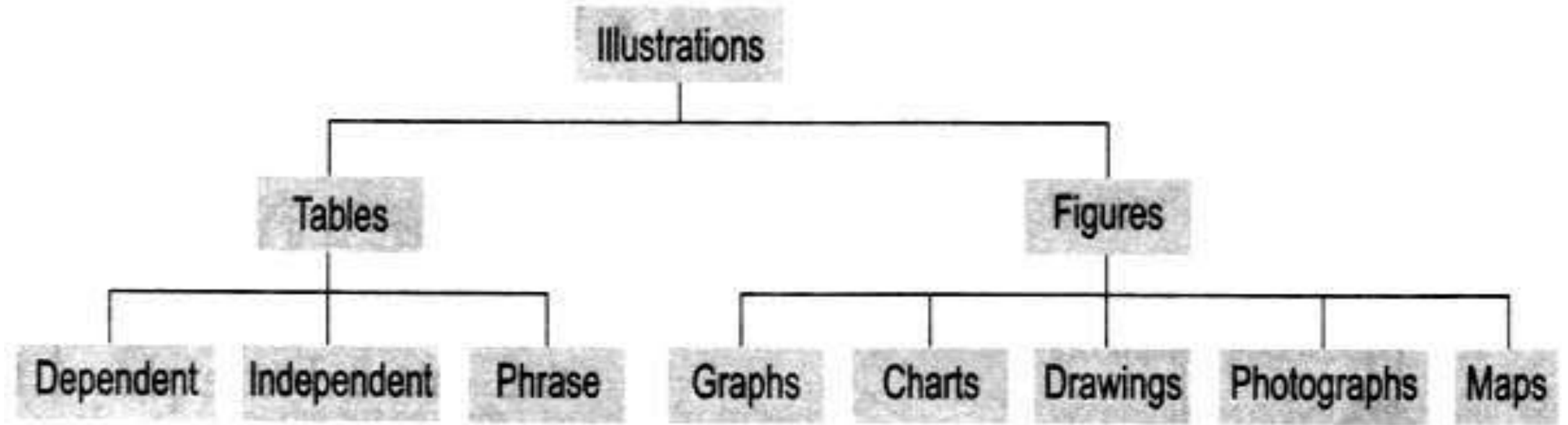
- ▶ Visual aids are an important part of written technical communication. Most technical reports, whether they are laboratory reports, project reports, or feasibility reports, include illustrations such as tables, graphs, maps, diagrams, charts, or photographs.
- ▶ Visual aids can be used to represent the following elements in technical writing:
 - Concepts
 - Objects
 - Numbers
 - Words



► Advantages of Visual Aids:

- ➔ Arouses interest and focuses on essentials.
- ➔ Leads reader to quicker comprehension.
- ➔ Support and reinforces words.
- ➔ Saves much time and effort in explaining and interpreting complex ideas.
- ➔ Simplifies numerical data.
- ➔ Emphasizes and clarifies certain facts and relationship.
- ➔ Makes the description vivid and eye-catching.
- ➔ Renders a professional flavor to the communication.

Types of Visual Aids:





Introduction:

- ▶ The word 'interview' comes from 'inter' and 'view'. 'Inter' means *in between*, and 'View' means *to see*.
- ▶ An interview is a process in which the employer gets an opportunity to see whether the candidate is suitable for the position vacant, and the candidate tries to prove that he/she possesses the desired skills and knowledge.

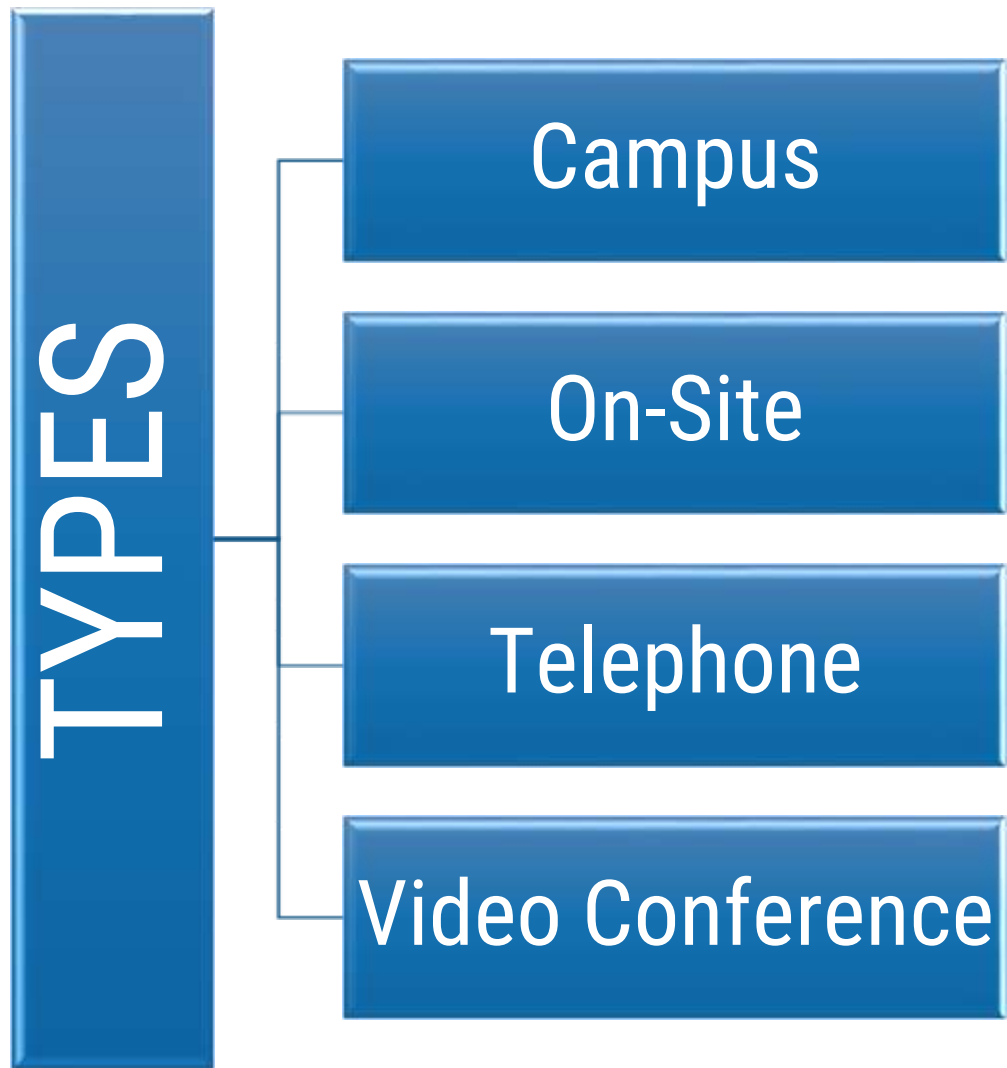


INTERVIEW

Types of Interview:

- ▶ Job
- ▶ Persuasive
- ▶ Evolution
- ▶ Conflict resolution
- ▶ Termination
- ▶ Information
- ▶ Exit
- ▶ Counselling
- ▶ Disciplinary
- ▶ Media

Job Interview:



Typical Selection Process:



Desirable Qualities:

- ▶ Clarity of thought
- ▶ Presence of mind
- ▶ Balanced point of view
- ▶ Cool composure
- ▶ Logical thinking
- ▶ Maturity
- ▶ Sincerity
- ▶ Openness
- ▶ Capacity to conceptualize
- ▶ Good understanding of fundamentals



Preparation:

- ▶ Know the Company
- ▶ Know Yourself
- ▶ Review Common Interview Questions



Using proper Verbal and Non-verbal Cues:

- ▶ Dress professionally, neatly groomed with polished shoes.
- ▶ Always walk with head up to show confidence.
- ▶ Shake hands with interviewer(s). Your handshake should be strong and firm.
- ▶ Sit up straight with your hands relaxing completely and lean slightly forward in your chair.
- ▶ Don't sit on the edge of the chair.
- ▶ Maintain eye contact.



- ▶ Don't forget to smile occasionally.
- ▶ Don't move your legs a lot.
- ▶ Do not rest one leg or ankle on top of your other knee.
- ▶ Avoid speaking in monotone.
- ▶ At the end of an interview, stand up and shake hands while you thank the interviewer for the opportunity.



Negotiation Skills

Negotiation - 1: Planning and preparation

▶ Types of negotiation

- ➔ Towards agreement: both teams try to arrive at joint interests.
- ➔ Independent advantage: each team aims to get best deal
- ➔ Conflict: a team aims to win and make the other team lose.

▶ Purpose of negotiation

- ➔ Exploratory (possible areas of interest)
- ➔ Conciliatory (resolving differences)

▶ Targets

- ➔ Scale (1-10)
- ➔ Decide realistic maximum and minimum acceptable scores.

► **Facts and figures**

- Prepare statistical data
- Known facts
- Prepare visuals

► **Strengths and weakness**

- List your bargaining strengths
- Know your possible weaknesses
- Calculate your bargaining position

► **Possible concessions**

- Plan your bargaining strategy
- List essential conditions: impossible to concede
- List possible concessions

► Opening statements

- ➔ State general objectives
- ➔ State priorities
- ➔ State independent (not joint) objectives
- ➔ Be brief

► Examples of general types of negotiations:

- ➔ Making an opening statement
 - Welcome to....
- ➔ First meeting
 - We see this as a preparatory meeting...
- ➔ One of a series of meetings
 - Following previous meetings, we have agreed on some important issues. Today we have to think about....

- ➔ Stating aims and objectives.
 - May I outline our main aims and objectives today...

- ➔ Stating shared aims and objectives
 - Together we want to develop a good relationship...

- ➔ Handing over
 - I would like to hand you over to my colleague...

Negotiation - 2: Bargaining in negotiations

► Concession rules

- Ask for concessions
- All concessions are conditional
- Conditions first “If...then...”
- It’s a package
- Give what’s cheap to you and valuable to them.

► During the negotiation

- Main Speaker
- Supporting Speaker

► Examples:

- Bargaining
 - If you could... we could consider...

- ➔ Accepting
 - We agree.

- ➔ Confirming
 - Can we run through we have agreed on?

- ➔ Summarizing
 - Can we summarize the proposals in a few words?

- ➔ Looking ahead
 - So, the next step is...

Negotiation - 3:

► Examples:

- Dealing with conflicts
 - I think we should look at the points we agree on...
- Rejecting
 - I don't think it would be sensible for us to...
- Ending negotiations
 - So, can we summarize the progress we've made?
- Breaking off negotiations
 - It's a pity we couldn't reach agreement this time.

Negotiation - 4:

► Dealing with conflict

- ➔ Shows understanding of the other side's position.
- ➔ Highlight advantages of agreement

► Don't ...

- ➔ Be sarcastic
- ➔ Attack
- ➔ Criticize
- ➔ Threaten
- ➔ Blame

► Do...

- ➔ Ask questions
- ➔ Listen
- ➔ Summarize
- ➔ Build on common ground
- ➔ Explain your feelings



Critical & Creative thinking in communication

Critical Thinking in Communication

- ▶ *Critical thinking* is the active, persistent, and careful consideration of beliefs or knowledge keeping in view the available evidence.
- ▶ It is a self-reflective process that involves elements of conceptualization, reasoning, analysis, interpretation, and evaluation of the available information upon which judgment is based.
- ▶ It includes the skills:
 - ➔ Making careful observations.
 - ➔ Being inquisitive and asking the relevant questions.
 - ➔ Challenging the beliefs, examining assumptions, and probing options which may even be against already established facts.

- ➔ Recognizing the problems and issue that may appear in future.
- ➔ Assessing the validity of statements and understanding the logic and strength of argument given.
- ➔ Making workable decisions and finding valid solutions.

► To be a critical thinker one needs to be:

- ➔ Inquisitive
- ➔ Judicious
- ➔ Systematic
- ➔ Truth seeking
- ➔ Analytical
- ➔ Confident in reasoning
- ➔ Open-minded

Creative Thinking in Communication

- ▶ *Creative thinking* is the generation of the new ideas within or across domains of knowledge. It requires preparation, incubation, insight, evaluation, elaboration, and communication.
- ▶ One must try to put aside the common assumptions, look beyond the conditioning that creates stereo types, prejudices, and parochial thinking to develop creative thinking.
- ▶ Few basic principles for including creative thinking:
 - ➔ Be open to new thoughts, ideas, and facts.
 - ➔ Keep your reading and listening faculty actively engaged in observation.
 - ➔ Regard the difficulty or a problem as an opportunity.

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- ➔ Enjoy the process of trying, learning and evolving.
- ➔ Avoid jumping to the conclusions; follow deferred judgments.
- ➔ Believe in cross-fertilization of ideas.
- ➔ Be your worst critic.